

The Two-Page Manifesto

ABSTRACT

Two pages forces you to prioritize.

1. Introduction

Two pages forces you to prioritize. What's really important? What can be left out?

2. Methodology

The two-page constraint. Everything important can fit on two pages. If it can't, it's not focused enough. We write too much. Documentation that no one reads. Specifications that are outdated before they're finished. Plans that change before they're implemented. When you're forced to fit on two pages, you have to be clear. No room for fluff. No room for ambiguity. You'll find that: You think more clearly You communicate better People actually read it Things get done. Two pages is readable. People will actually read it. And if they read it, they might act on it.

3. Conclusion

Two pages is easy to update. When things change, you update two pages. Not twenty. Not two hundred. One idea per document. Don't try to cover everything. Focus. Link to details. The two-page doc is the summary. Link to detailed docs for those who need them. Two pages: The decision, the rationale, the trade-offs, the impact. Try it. Take your next document. Cut it to two pages. See what happens. The two-page constraint doesn't limit what you can say. It forces you to say what matters.